MATTHEW NICHOLS

HONORS URBAN STUDIES AND ECONOMICS STUDENT

PROFILE

Senior Urban Studies student at McGill University who is passionate about developing resilient and equitable urban spaces. Brings knowledge of programming / web development, GIS, and experience in conducting a research project as well as coordinating and leading a local garden planting project.

SKILLS

- Experience performing data analysis in ArcGIS and Python
- Knowledge of JavaScript, HTML / CSS for creating websites from scratch
- Experience using Mapbox to create interactive web maps
- Experience using APIs such as the Google geocoding API, the US Census API, and the Tomorrow weather API

EDUCATION

McGill University

2024/2026

Major: Geography (Urban Studies, Honors)
Minor: Economics
GPA: 3.68
Relevant Classes Taken:

- Intro to Geo Information Science: A- (GEOG 201)
- Cities in the Modern World: A (GEOG 217)
- Intro to Coding A (COMP 202)
- Intro to Programming: B- (COMP 250)
- Principles of the Geospatial Web: A- (GEOG 384)
- Geospatial Analysis: A (GEOG 314)
- Geographic Thought and Practice: A (GEOG 381)
- Linear Algebra and Geometry: A (MATH 133)
- Urban Geography: In Progress (GEOG 417)
- Real Estate Finance: In Progress (FINE 445)
- Advanced Geospatial Analysis: Spring 2027 (GEOG 414)
- Topic: Geodatabases, ML, & GeoAI: Spring 2027 (GEOG 406)
- Real Estate and Planning: Spring 2027 (URBP 555)
- Urban Field Studies: Spring 2027 (GEOG 494)
- Honors Research: In Progress (GEOG 491)

James Madison High School

2020-2024

Weighted GPA: 4.2
Honors Graduate

EXPERIENCE

Job Experience

- McGill University: Research Assistant (Dr. Gregory Weitzner) — February 2026 - Present
  - Data processing in python, exploratory data analysis
- Vienna, VA, Planning and Zoning: Intern — June - August 2026
  - Created a fact book for the town, did research to advise the comprehensive plan, worked on setup for an open data portal
- Roeder, Cochran, Phillips, PLLC: Litigation Document Review — June - August 2024
  - Read emails, sorted into categories for future review
- Safeway (Grocery Store): Courtesy Clerk — January - June 2024
  - Stocked, cleaned, helped customers, moved carts

Honors Thesis

- Writing a project proposal, pitching ideas to a supervisor — March 2026 - Present
- Conducting research and performing data analysis in Python, interpreting results

Career Shadow

May - June 2024

- With bKL Architecture (D.C. office)
- Observed every step of the architecture process, from the idea phase to construction management, sat in on OAC meetings and site visits

Pollinator Garden (Eagle Scout Project)

2023

- Coordinating with authorities and organizations
- Advertising and fundraising, working with donors
- Designing garden layout, creating diagrams and planning documents
- Leading a team of 30+ people, managing groups and timing

CONTACT: (703) 965 2596 matthewnich015@outlook.com

LANGUAGES: English: Fluent French: B2 Level